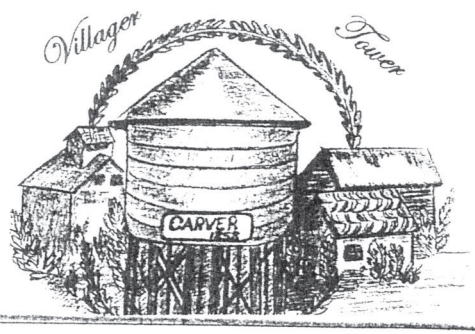
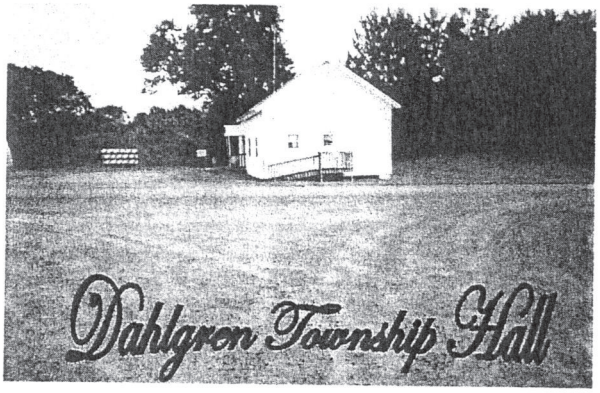
Volume XXIV
Number # Two Hundred Twenty Eight
September / October 2006




## Dahlgren Township Board Meeting Announcement

Due to the unfortunate and untimely destruction of the Dahlgren Township Hall, the board would like to announce that their October 10th Board Meeting will be held on Tuesday instead of Monday due to the holiday observance and they will be meeting at the Zoar United Church of Christ Basement, 7030 Highway #212, Chaska at 7:30 PM.

Dahlgren residents and registered voters also should make note that the November 7th General Election will be held at the Dahlgren Golf Club in the Banquet Room, at 6940 Dahlgren Road, Chaska MN from 7 AM to 8 PM.




Picture credit: Janice Buckentine

On September 16th, 2006 the building identified as the Dahlgren Township Hall was destroyed by fire. The only evidence left of its once visible existence are only all the memories in the minds of those who have either passed by or through the building known as the Dahlgren Township Hall over the past century. The property was purchased in June of 1888, it was said. Mention was also made that the tract of land cost the township a mere $30. The hall itself was believed to have been built shortly after the purchase of the land. Just east of the hall there also used to be an equipment shed, but has been gone for several years now. It's hard to even tell there was a building beside the hall. To the west of where the hall once stood is a building they refer to as a 'quonset shed' believed to have been constructed approximately fifty years ago.

It has also been recorded that the township was settled in 1854, organized in April of 1864 on the 5th day and was named "Liberty" in 1863. Suggestion was submitted to change it's name by the state auditor because Liberty had already been appropriated by another town in the state. On May 9th, 1864 the name was changed to "Dahlgren" to honor the distinguished "Admiral John Adolphus Bernard Dahlgren of Swedish parentage and born in Philadelphia. Dahlgren in Sections 10 & 15 had a station of the Chicago, Milwaukee and St Paul Railroad, a post office, 1872-1876, John Lorfield being the first postmaster at his hotel; a flour mill; and a sash and door factory.

Were you also aware that townships were the original form of local government in the State of Minnesota? They were established as part of the Northwest Ordinance of 1787, which created the State of Minnesota.

Further research of the history of Dahlgren Township turned up the information that one board member in the early 1900's was Frank Trende. Also in the same era was Andrew Skoog, who was the assessor for the township and served as the clerk for many years. Frank Mieseler had also served as the township clerk. The order in which these gentlemen held these titles is not certain, merely at some point they all shared these responsibilities. William Meuleners is still another name you'll find in the documentations of Dahlgren's history. It was said that his father, native of Holland was one of the first settlers in Carver County. Mr Meuleners, it appears served several terms as treasurer for the township, possibly in the latter decades of 1800's. Records also indicated that Henry Eiden, possibly also in the latter 1800's served as supervisor and chairman of the board, as well as assessor for many years.

A century later some other board members to serve the township were Henry Heitkamp, Ed Nord, Ivan Hurtig who also served as the Treasurer. Richard (Vic) Walter was the clerk. The most recent board members of the township are Gene Miller, Jack Murphy, Art Buckentine and John Stelton. Janice Buckentine is the clerk. I'm sure if one took the time to sit down and talk with these people, you could learn a lot of important history and memories that could fill a book.

Then there are the employees who worked for the township. Some of them were Wayne Severson, also known as "Tuffy" who was a long time employee and standby, Norman Paul, Joe Poppler and Wally Buetow. At present Olson Construction does the township's road maintenance. One former employee stated that there was sixty three miles of town ship roads to maintain. There was plowing, grading, and hauling gravel.

Isn't it a shame that it takes the destruction of an historical artifact for us to stop and think about what exactly transpires on a daily basis in each and every facet of life? How much we don't know, how much we don't remember, how much we don't have time to think about. How each and every item on this earth has something to contribute, no matter how minute or how big. It all serves a purpose, it all has it's reason and some where in the history everything contributed to where we are now and where we are going. Take a moment to just stop and look around you, absorb it slowly, for tomorrow it may be gone and can never be brought back again.



## Budget WorkShop

The council held a work session to discuss budget issues. The proposed budget presented to the council demonstrated an increase, which would require increasing the property taxes. This proposal was not favorable. The proposal was reviewed to list possible cuts that could be made. Additional review of the topic would be necessary. Another work session was scheduled. The council continued discussion of the preliminary budget. Issues were reviewed further and agreement was made on a proposed budget.

## Private Wells

Mr Terry Bovee spoke to the council regarding an item called "Wellhead Protection" and what this program means to the City of Carver. The city is a small community and would receive technical assistance from the state. This program is in the early stages and is also an unfunded mandated program. The MN Department of Health has been granted the authority to implement wellhead protection under MN statutes. The mayor inquired about the cost to the city. It was explained that the city would not receive a bill from the State of MN for their technical help, which would include managing an inner wellhead management zone. This included a two hundred foot radius surrounding a public water supply and locating all the private wells of the delineated well head protection area and identify them on a map. The owners of private wells would be contacted. As part of the program private owners will be educated on the care of a private well.

## Municipal Utilities

The Municipal Utilities supervisor told the council that the motor in the well had shorted out and was replaced. The annual inspection of the water plant had taken place by the Department of Health. The council was told that the inspectors were impressed with the cleanliness of the plant. Chlorine tests at various locations had proved to be good as well. Security concerns at the Water Treatment Plant were questioned. A security system is in place.

## City Planner

Council member inquired about the T-Mobile information for antenna location in the City's Planner report. She explained that the antenna request was being discussed with the company so that a suitable location can be determined and agreed upon.

The council also discussed with the city planner the adoption of the resolution authorizing the distribution of the drafted Comprehensive Plan. She explained that state law required the draft Comprehensive Plan be submitted to local governments for review prior to approval by the city and subsequent forwarding to the Metropolitan Council. She stated that this reviewing process takes approximately six months. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution ordering authorizing distribution of the city's drafted Comprehensive Plan for adjacent governmental units and affected school district review.

## River Bluff Estates

The council discussed the timeline for completion of the development of the River Bluff Estates. The developer informed the council that they are in the process of obtaining approval for the retaining wall and grading will continue until completion. A meeting would be scheduled with the engineer to discuss ponding issues. The developer anticipated completion prior to deadline set by the development agreement. The Letter of Credit was discussed. It was understood that the city could use the letter to complete the work. Agreement was reached that if the project were not completed on time that the city would ensure completion.

## Comprehensive Plan

Several sections of the Comprehensive Plan were presented to the council for their review. The council and the consultant reviewed questions and reports. The engineering department had input for the drafted Comprehensive Plan and there would be revisions submitted after other governmental factions have also reviewed the drafted copy.

The city planner attended the Dahlgren Township Board meeting and updated the board on both the Alternate Urban Area Review Study and the Comprehensive Plan. There were tentative plans to schedule a Public Hearing in October on these issues. City and township residents would be invited to the hearing. The township was also asked about interest in a joint plan for the Comprehensive Plan. A resolution would have to be drafted after the Metropolitan Council forwards a system statement to the cities. The township requested to have the plan sent to the township for public comment.

## Spring Creek Lift Station

The engineer told the council that the contractor had installed the lift station on the site after building pads were constructed. Due to the type of soils, the depth of the structure and the size of the excavation around the lift station caused the site to become larger than originally anticipated. Because of the disturbances caused by construction other problems have arisen for the developer nearby. Request was submitted to propose additional geotechnical investigation to determine the extent of the disturbance. The city engineer recommended an investigation under the city's direction at this time. Final cost breakdown with everyone would be negotiated later. Most of the work had been done in the right-of-way as planned. Further discussion was held regarding what was done, those responsible for making decisions and what if's. The council discussed financial responsibility. It was the opinion of one council member that the developer should have financial obligation since soils in the area had been changed after soil borings had been done by the lift station site and were fully aware of the plans to construct the lift station on the site. Motion was made and carried with three ayes and two nays that the city pays a portion and the developer pay the balance for the additional geotechnical investigation.

## Did You Know...

....that already by 1878 Carver had a telegraph system that was served by the Northwestern Express, American Express, and the United States Express companies.

## Fish and Wildlife Service

The Fish and Wildlife Service personnel submitted a request for variances from the city ordinance regarding hunting within the city limits on refuge land. The city attorney recommended that the ordinance be amended but that the variance not be granted. The council was asked for guidance. The ordinance would be reviewed, The Fish and Wildlife Service personnel and schedule these items for the next council meeting for review.

## Carver Tax Service

Cathy's Tax Tip for September/October

Now that school has started again, it's a good time to remind everyone with children in grades K-12 to save your itemized cash register receipts for the purchase of required educational materials. This includes textbooks, paper, pencils, notebooks, rulers, etc for use during the regular school day. This applies to public school as well as private and home school students. These items qualify for either a credit for Minnesota tax or a subtraction from Minnesota taxable income, depending on taxable income. There are other education expenses that also qualify for either the credit or subtraction. Enrichment programs, tutoring, music lessons and home computer hardware and educational software are just a few of the other expenses that qualify. For more information, check the instruction booklet for the 2005 MN Individual Income Tax or MN Revenue's website, www.taxes.state.mn.us or call me at 952) 240-5279 or e-mail me at carvertax@mn.rr.com. Saving these receipts now should help you shave your MN income tax for 2006!

*Cathy L. Steigerwald, E.A.*

## The Gehl House

The Heritage Preservation Commission discussed the Gehl House in San Francisco Township. Originally the Fish and Wildlife Service had intended to utilize the structure for a service center, however, it is in the flood plain area. Even though the house has never been physically flooded the Fish and Wildlife Service cannot use it. A Public Hearing has been scheduled at the Village Hall concerning the structure. The building is very large and too costly to move. The location is quite nice, as well.

## Tentative Agenda

City of Carver Council
Monday Evening 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Pledge of Allegiance
3) Approve Agenda
4) Petitions and Requests
5) Consent Agenda
6) Municipal Utilities Report
7) Building Inspector Report
8) City Planner Report
9) City Engineer Report
10) City Attorney Report
11) Administrator Report
12) Liaison Reports
13) Other Business
14) Adjourn

## 2007 Budget

The city administrator presented to the Park and Recreation Board an overview of the budget process. The Park and Recreation Board's budget is funded with tax revenue not from park programs. The public works supervisor and the park program director generated the budget from needs and item that should be included in the park's 2007 budget. The board members were asked to review the proposal and delete items to decrease the bottom line. The city planner would review the Capitol Improvement Program portion with the board. The board reviewed the budget carefully.

Discussion was held on the necessity of installation of an irrigation system for Lions Park. The Lions are also reviewing this topic. Water usage for this system is required to be budgeted for. The city planner stated that the top six park improvement estimated for 2007 consideration were the Community Park Shelter, RiverSide Park improvements Phase I, Lions Park irrigation, Depot Park and land acquisition for Depot Park. The board discussed the Snake Road Trail. This trail would not connect with the road because a large piece is privately owned. Plans are to continue the trail from the Grimm property. The cost for that continuance is scheduled for the City's General Fund. Maintenance and additional equipment in established parks are allowed. Park dedication fees cannot be utilized to achieve those goals. The city planner pointed out that the use of park dedication fees vary from park to park.

The board questioned where the board would be in five years. The need to proceed with their own programs now would give a direction for the community and asked what level of services would be offered to the residents of Carver. The members discussed what programs and facilities should be available to the residents. Then the question was asked about the city having their own community center. Question was also asked about a second high school in the area. Traffic impact and the possibility of teaming with the City of Chaska to build a new center. The board also discussed Dahlgren Golf Course proposal.

The city planner told the board of the necessity to choose the top priority projects. There were questions regarding the importance of skate board park and additional costs. However, it was the board's consensus that this project should have top priority. Then the board discussed various issues relating to the baseball/softball items and whether or not remodeling or adding for storage should be completed. This item was removed from the priority list. The second item the board named as important involved the RiverSide Park improvements. Depot Park was third and then bumped to fourth on the priority list with items being split into phases. The third project involved the Snake Road Trail.

The city planner reviewed the trail plan proposed for the city. The board reviewed and discussed the proposal to great length. There were many items that were required to fill in areas. Additional trails would be considered when future development occurs.

The US Fish and Wildlife Manager and personnel discussed the trail connections proposals with the Park and Recreation Board members. There were discussions concerning the refuge trail system and bridges being installed in the Rapids Lake unit and attempts to connect with the Chaska unit. Discussions were also held regarding land swap in Bluff Park.

## Prosecution Agreement

The county attorney, Fahey informed the council that the cities within the county have been informed of the county's decision to have the county attorney's office recover fifty percent of the cost for prosecution services provided to the cities. Costs associated for the City of Carver revealed that fine revenues reflected towards balance have reduced costs and therefore the city is in compliance.

## Congratulations

Congratulations Shawn and Phil! Their daughter, Cassandra Lee was born on Thursday, September 28, 2006 at Ridgeview Medical Center at 3:53 AM. Cassandra weighed in at and even 6lbs and was 19" long. This is Shawn and Phil's first born. Grandpa is Tom Dauwalter, alias Hooker. Congratulations Grandpa and Aunt Erin, too!!!!

"Angels Exist, but sometimes, since they don't all have wings, we call them friends."

## Elm Drive

The city engineer informed the council that portions of the existing Elm Drive had been reconstructed with the Carver Creek 9th Addition. Also that bollards were placed along the east end of the reconstruction portion of Elm Drive at the cul-de-sac. The Public Works Department and the Fire Department will have authorized access. The council discussed the name of the street with changes that have occurred with the reconstruction. Request was made to include a sign on the street reading "No Outlet". Three options were submitted regarding the street designation. One was no change. The second option included adding "east" to the old part of Elm Drive and "west" to the new portion. The last option would be to add address designations to street signs below the name signs. Statement was given that too much information on street signs only causes confusion. Motion was made and carried with all ayes changing the name for the newer portion of Elm Drive to Elm Drive West.

## Alternate Urban Area Review

The city planner and engineer were available at the council meeting to discuss the authorization of the distribution of the drafted Northwest and Southwest Alternate Urban Area Review studies. A slide presentation was presented to the council on both of the studies. The purpose of the Alternate Urban Area Review studies were to analyze the potential impacts from development proposed in the city's drafted Comprehensive Plan and includes mitigation plans with strategies to avoid, minimize or mitigate for the identified impacts. The city planner pointed out that the Alternate Urban Area Review studies are only effective for five years, however a two year extension could be requested. The documents will be available on the city's website for the public's review. Motions were made and carried with all ayes adopting both resolutions ordering the distribution of a draft Alternate Urban Area Review for the northwest and southwest area of Carver.

## Carver Depot Caboose

Have you seen it? Did you see it? Did you even notice anything different? Did you see? Did ya'? Did ya'? Hugh? Hugh? Did ya'? See what?

Paul has reported that the new lettering and logos are in place on the caboose at the Carver Depot. Thanks to Ken Forner of Promotion Graphics who made the decals and applied them to the caboose. Great Job! If you didn't notice, or haven't been through town to see, here's an attempt to bring it to you.




9/28/06

## Fire Department

The Fire Department personnel would like to extend their gratitude to everyone for attending the SteamBoat Day's festivities this year and for visiting the safety trailer and cheering on participants at the water fights. Plans are already in the works for next year's events.

The Fire Department would like to invite everyone to their Third Annual Open House to be held on October 14th from 3 to 6 PM celebrating National Fire Safety Week. The personnel would like and encourage everyone to help the department celebrate another productive, successful year in the new facility. Engine rides will be given along with tours of the station. There will also be extrication demonstrations, which could be very enlightening along with other educational activities. There will be Fire/Safety awareness information, child games, truck rides. And don't forget the refreshments offered too. Like chili and hot dogs? Refreshments will also be available. Come say 'hi'.

## East Union Country Fare

Saturday, October 7th from 10 AM to 2 PM at the East Union Church is the Country Fare. They are featuring handmade crafts, a quilt raffle, collectible items and antiques, baked goods, and garden produce and last but not least, pumpkins. Come to shop, stay for a real "Lutheran" luncheon!! Proceeds from this fundraiser will go towards the plans for their 150th Anniversary coming up in two years, another portion to the University of MN Cancer Research Program and another portion to the American Diabetes Association. Hope to see you at our Country Fare. You never know what treasures you may find there.

## Fall Harvest Chicken Dinner

And then in November, the East Union Church will be organizing their Fall Harvest Chicken Dinner to be held on November 5th at the hall from 4 to 6 PM. The purpose of the event is to invite a neighbor and give thanks for the harvest. The proceeds from this event are used for kitchen supplies for the church kitchen. Questions about the event, call the church for more information at 952) 4483450.

## Annual Costume Halloween Party

One of the goals of the Carver Lions is to give the kids in the community a night of fun. Therefore, on the 28th of October, it's a Saturday, the Lions are sponsoring the Annual Costume Halloween Party at the Village Hall for the preschoolers and kids through the fifth grad. There will be games, prizes, drawings, costume prizes and treats. The games will be from 5 to 6:15 PM. Then the drawings until 7 PM. Admission is $2.00 plus a non-perishable food item. Reminder, preschool age and kindergarten age children must be accompanied by an adult.

Also, volunteers are need for the party. Volunteers would help with the carnival games. Sixth grade age youths are welcome to volunteer too. All youth volunteers dressed for the occasion in costume will be eligible for a special cash prize drawing. This is the twenty-first year the Lions have been hosting the party, be sure to come and join in the fun and volunteer to help and keep a wonderful tradition going. If interested in volunteering call Cheryl Peterson at 952) 448-4857. Leave a name and number. Thanks!

Careful in the dark of those things that go bump in the night.

## Chili Feed

Carver Second Alarm (Retired Carver Fire Department) will be hosting their Eleventh Annual Chili Feed on October 29th from 11 AM to 5 PM. The Chili Feed will be served at the Village Hall. The proceeds from the event benefit children with birth defects! You can purchase advance tickets for $5 or buy them at the door for $6. (or donate what your heart feels would be appropriate). There will also be a Silent Auction and Meat Raffle. Tickets are available from Lenzen Chevrolet-Buick or Swanson Insurance. Be sure to come and enjoy a good meal, take a chance on the raffle, maybe buy something you didn't know you needed and help a kid! See you there.

## Carver's Women's Business Group

Given any more thought to joining in on the Village Christmas spirit? Be part of the home tours for sharing your decorations with the rest of the interested world to promote someone else's decorating of their home? The Carver's Women's Business Group is still accepting homes for the tour scheduled for the second Saturday in December, the 9th. There's still time to get ready. Contact Barb Swanson if you are interested at 952) 448-4580.





## Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar — October 2006

October 2nd - Council Meeting
Yom Kippur
October 3rd - Carver's Women's Business Group Meeting
October 4th - Lions Meeting
October 5th - Drill Night
School Board Meeting
October 6th - Homecoming
October 7th - Congratulations John and Kim! – Wedding Day
Happy Anniversary Kari & Guy!
Happy Birthday Megan!
October 9th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Referendum Information Clinic
6:30 PM – at Pioneer Ridge Freshmen Center
Columbus Day Observed
Happy Birthday Linda!
Happy Birthday Laurie!
October 10th - Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
October 11th - Happy Birthday Ryan!
October 12th - Columbus Day
October 14th - Fire Department Open House
3 PM – 6 PM
October 15th - Happy Birthday Andrea!
October 16th - Council Meeting
Drill Night
October 17th - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
October 18th - Joint Meeting for Alternate Urban Area Review Study
October 19th - Happy Birthday Annette!
October 21st - Happy Birthday Larry!
October 23rd - Comprehensive Plan Work Group Meeting
October 24th - Planning Commission Meeting
United Nations Day
October 26th - Fire Department Meeting Night
School Board Meeting
Happy Birthday Carl!
Happy Birthday Kate!
October 28th - Annual Costume Halloween Party
October 29th - Daylight Savings Time Ends
11th Annual Chili Feed
Happy Anniversary Glen & Joycelyn!
October 31st - Halloween
Happy Birthday Phil!

## From one pumpkin to another!!!!!!!

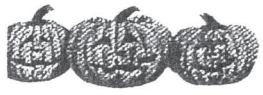
A woman was asked by a coworker, "What is it like to be a Christian?"

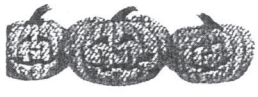
The coworker replied, "It is like being a pumpkin." God picks you from the patch, brings you in, and washes all the dirt off of you. Then He cuts off the top and scoops out all the yucky stuff.

He removes the seeds of doubt, hate, and greed. Then He carves you a new smiling face and puts His light inside of you to shine for all the world to see."

This was passed on to me by another pumpkin. Now it's your turn to pass it to other pumpkins.

I liked this enough to send it to all the pumpkins in my patch.





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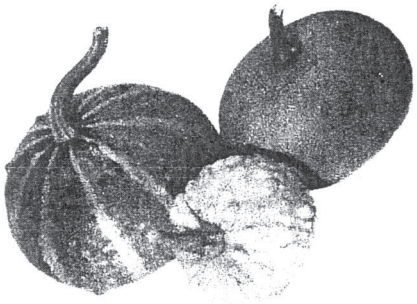
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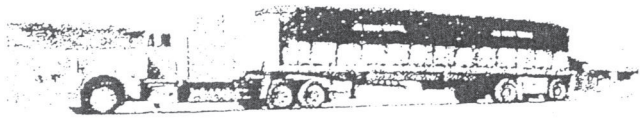
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